9 Continue in this fashion down to the chimney and detail using a 6mm skew chisel. Sand and then seal the grain with friction polish before parting off using a 4mm parting tool

10 Take the internal dimension of the lid with Verniers, then transfer this to the remaining material as a guide to the external flange over which the lid should be a fairly tight fit. Obtaining a good fit usually entails several attempts

11 The box section is now ready for hollowing. With a 10mm spindle gouge sharpened to a fingernail profile, use push cuts and then pull cuts to remove the timber quickly. However, the deeper you go the more risk there is of vibration on thin bladed tools, so I used a 10mm swept-back grind bowl gouge to deepen the hollow to a depth of 46mm. Clean up the inner base and square off with a box scraper

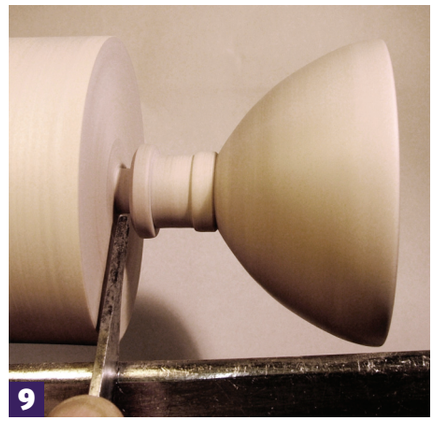
12 Now, the outer box profile can be established with a 10mm spindle gouge and 10mm round skew. Then, as with the lid, sand and seal the grain

13 Next, part of and turn down the remaining waste with a 6mm beading and parting tool to fit the inside of the box, this provides a 'jam' chuck that will drive the reversed box between centres so as to allow the base to be decorated and nicely finished

14 Clean up the base with light cuts from the 10mm spindle gouge ...

15 ... before applying your desired decoration using the long point of a small skew

16 Colouring and decoration is very much a matter of choice. I chose to spray the lid – and lathe – while slowly revolving in the lathe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HANDY HINTS

1. This project is suitable for individual expression and the use of different media. Pyrography would be ideal to give crisp outlines, or maybe add some three-dimensional carving
2. My cottage is a charming thatched example but it could be of a completely different design, don't be afraid to experiment
3. This is, in essence, a decorated lidded box, you could create a one-off container to commemorate a special event
4. It is essential to use dry timber to ensure that the lid remains a good tight-ish push fit. To make it more coin-secure, one could create a threaded lid

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